APOLLO · DESIGN-SYSTEM ENGINE

Apollo

A governed engine for designing with AI — on brand, accessible, at speed.

IN THE NEXT SIXTEEN MINUTES

Five chapters, one build, a live graph, minimal slides.

1

The introduction

Why we are here today

What Apollo is for, in one sentence, and the shape of the next quarter-hour.

2

The problem and goal

How we got here

An assembly line is only as fast as its parts bin. Two measured gains, and the hypothesis the pilot tests.

3

The system working

What I want to show you

A frozen prompt goes in, unedited. We watch it build, then drive what lands.

4

The system’s shape

What is Apollo?

Four moving parts, no black box — and the knowledge graph underneath, which you can ask why.

5

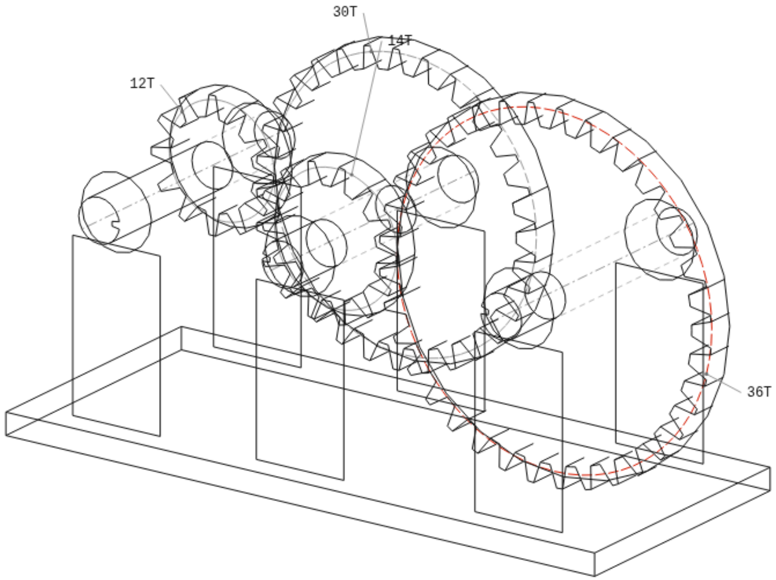
The ambition for Apollo

Where this could go

Where it goes, what it needs, and what I am asking for.

PLOT POINT 03 · THE PROBLEM, IN ONE METAPHOR

The parts bin



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PLOT POINT 04 · THE CLAIM

Two measured gains, stacked — and **the hypothesis the pilot tests**.

15%

A major bank's own published figure

Coding-time efficiency across 20,000+ developers.

47%

IBM Carbon, no AI

Same form, 4.2 h → 2.0 h with a design system. The library alone.

6 months → 6 weeks?

Hypothesis, measured by the pilot

Not a result. "How do you know six weeks?" — "I don't. That is K1."

Sources: a major bank's published AI-efficiency figure · Sparkbox's IBM Carbon study.

PLOT POINT 05 · THE ONLY MEASURED BEFORE-AND-AFTER WE OWN

BEFORE — 8 SEPTEMBER, FIRST RUN

2	2	0	2
Visually rich	Full	Persistent	Interactive

→

AFTER — SAME DAY, FIFTH BLIND RUN

3	3	3	2
Visually rich	Full	Persistent	Interactive

Four axes — visually rich, full, persistent, interactive — nought to three each. Five blind runs in one day, each one finding a real defect. Self-scored, and every point verified by driving the page in a browser, not by reading the source.

Source: our own cold-run scorecard, 8 September 2026.

—— PLOT POINT 05 · PREDICTED KPIS — FIVE, EACH WITH AN EXTERNAL BASELINE

	NAME	BASELINE	TARGET ON THE FIRST LIVE PROJECT
K1	Time to first gated screen	Sparkbox 4.2 h → 2.0 h	Same-day for a multi-screen flow — the only KPI the demo produces live
K2	Library reuse rate	GitClear: AI duplication up 8×	≥80% of rendered UI from gated components
K3	Change-failure rate	DORA 2025: AI adoption correlates with worse stability	No worse than the team's pre-AI rate — explicitly not an improvement
K4	Research-analysis cycle time	JMIR 2024: 492 → 15 min, 71–90% consistency	≥70% on the analysis step; fieldwork hours unchanged and reported separately
K5	Coding-time efficiency	The bank's own published 15%	Match it on the front-end build. Promise no more.

Sources: published industry studies. Designer-hours, headcount and "×" multipliers are deliberately excluded.

BEAT 3 · RUN THE DEMO

Live build.

The frozen prompt, cold. One prompt, one compliant dashboard, nothing edited.

SWITCH TO THE EDITOR

Live and unedited: the frozen prompt, run cold.

PLOT POINT 10 · THE SYSTEM, SIMPLY

Four moving parts.
No black box.

01

Canon

The design tokens and the reviewed, gated components — the single source of truth for what “on brand” means.

02

Gates

Executable checks for brand fidelity and accessibility. Not guidance — enforcement that can withhold “done”.

03

Runbooks

The method: how a task is generated, retrieved, and reviewed. Repeatable, inspectable, improvable.

04

Host agent

The AI that operates it — running today in the editor designers already have.

Portable by design — no bespoke runtime. Source: the Apollo sponsor briefing, July 2026.

PLOT POINT 11 · THE KNOWLEDGE GRAPH — DIG, SCRUB, TRACE, AND ASK IT WHY

The graph is **the source of truth.**

Live graph — 2,837 nodes · 4,902 edges. The same field as the title card, only now you can drive it.

SWITCH TO THE KNOWLEDGE-GRAPH EXPLORER

Source: the live Apollo knowledge graph, 11 September 2026.

DRAFT — THE ASK SLOT IS DAVE'S AND IS NOT RULED

One live project, sponsored — six weeks on the clock, K1–K5 measured against your own published fifteen percent. If it doesn't beat your number, you've lost six weeks. If it does, you own the stack.

Draft wording. The ask is not settled — amount and shape are still open.

IN CLOSING

Apollo

The build is automated.
The craft is the point.

2,837 nodes · 4,902 edges